

Ministry of Water, Land and Resource Stewardship

UPDATE: Flood Warning – Englishman River (UPGRADE)

Flood Watch: Vancouver Island, South Coast, Lower Fraser

High Streamflow Advisory – Haida Gwaii, North Coast, Central Coast, Lillooet River and Tributaries

Issued: 7:15 AM January 12, 2026

The River Forecast Centre is **upgrading** to a **Flood Warning** for:

- Englishman River

The River Forecast Centre is **maintaining** a Flood Watch for:

- Central Vancouver Island including areas around Port Alberni
- Eastern Vancouver Island including the Englishman River and areas around Courtenay, Bowser, Qualicum and Parksville (except Englishman River at Flood Warning)
- Southern Vancouver Island including the Chemainus River, Cowichan River and surrounding areas
- Northern Vancouver Island
- Western Vancouver Island
- South Coast - Sunshine Coast, Howe Sound, and North Shore Mountains
- Lower Fraser including areas around the Fraser Valley and Metro Vancouver (UPGRADE)

The River Forecast Centre is **maintaining** a High Streamflow Advisory for:

- Haida Gwaii
- North Coast including areas around Kitimat, Prince Rupert and surrounding areas
- Central Coast including Bella Coola, Kingcome and outer coastal areas
- South Coast – remaining areas including the Sea-to-Sky
- Lower Fraser – Lillooet River and tributaries around Pemberton

Weather Synopsis:

A series of atmospheric rivers is impacting coastal British Columbia. Prolonged periods of moderate to heavy rain are expected, along with warmer temperatures and additional runoff

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from rain-on-snow melt. Environment and Climate Change have rainfall warnings in effect across regions, with forecast rainfall amounts Saturday through Monday of 100 to 200 mm on Western Vancouver Island, 90 to 135 mm on Inland Vancouver Island, 75 to 100 mm on Eastern Vancouver Island, 75 to 150 mm in the North Shore and 70 to 100 mm in the Fraser Valley. Temperatures are expected to rise into next week, with the potential for significant snowmelt (25 to 100 mm) from yesterday through Tuesday, particularly on mid-elevation terrain on Vancouver Island, Sunshine Coast and North Shore Mountains/Howe Sound.

River Conditions:

Localized high flows are expected due to heavy rainfall rates and rain-on-snow melt runoff throughout the coastal region. Peak river levels are expected through Monday on Vancouver Island and the South Coast. Current flows on the Englishman River have reached or exceeded flood level (360 m³/s at the WSC gauge). Flows may reach or exceed 5-year to 10-year flows in areas under Flood Watch, and 2-year to 5-year flows in other areas. Expected impacts include the potential for road washouts, localized flooding, overbank flow, swift water hazards and landslides. Extra vigilance is appropriate through the weekend and into Monday, with the expectation that this weather pattern could lead to escalating flood hazard.

Stay away from riverbanks. Do not drive through flooded roads and washouts. Check road conditions in advance on [DriveBC](#) and be prepared for travelling conditions. Review personal flood response plans and be prepared to take appropriate action.

The [River Forecast Centre](#) continues to monitor the conditions and will provide updates as conditions warrant.

For information on how to prepare for flood hazards, visit [PreparedBC](#).

BC River Forecast Centre

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A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Fast-flowing bodies of water increase risk to life safety. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.

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